DECISION MAKING

Eligibility Criteria and Courses of Action

OAVS TGT | Reasoning (Additional topic from the “etc.” in the syllabus) | Topic 27

Syllabus line (Reasoning, 30 Marks): The verbal and non-verbal topics listed in the syllabus end with “etc.”. This topic is not named in that line, but it is asked in the papers: eligibility questions (English 2019 Q45, English 2022 Q50) and a course-of-action question (Mathematics 2024 Q97) appear.

Built from: OAVS TGT English 2019, English 2022, Mathematics 2024, Science 2024 and Social Studies 2023 (17 May 2023, Shift 2). Three questions appear (English 2019 Q45, English 2022 Q50 and Mathematics 2024 Q97). All three are solved below. The practice questions were generated or checked by program so that each has exactly one correct option.

What is inside

Ch.	Title	What you get
1	PYQ Analysis	The 3 PYQs and their types
2	Foundation	Criteria checking, exceptions and rules for courses of action
3	Solved PYQs	3 PYQs with step-by-step reasoning
4	Shortcuts, Traps and Scope	Speed methods and mistakes
5	Practice Set	6 original questions with a verified key
6	Quick Revision	One-page cheat sheet

CHAPTER 1

PYQ Analysis

Three questions, three papers

Paper	Q.	Question	Type	Ans
English 2019	45	Recruitment criteria with two exceptions; is Sumitra selected?	Eligibility	A (selected)
English 2022	50	Exam criteria with reserved category and Ph.D. relaxation; which conclusions follow?	Criteria and conclusions	B (only I)
Mathematics 2024	97	Saxena wants to quit his BPO job and start a footwear business; courses of action	Course of action	A (i and ii)
Science 2024 / Social Studies 2023	–	none		

PYQ INSIGHT: Two PYQs are **rule-checking** questions: read every criterion, check the candidate against each, and apply the exception only if its condition is met exactly. The third is a **course of action** question, where the actions must be **practical, directly useful** and must not **reject the plan**.

Pattern	PYQs	Priority
Eligibility: check each criterion and the exceptions	2	★★★ Must
Course of action: pick the actions that follow	1	★★★ Must
Conclusions on criteria (can apply or not)	0	★★ Expected

CHAPTER 2

Foundation

Checking criteria and judging actions

2.1 Eligibility questions

Step	Do this
1	List every criterion with its number or limit (marks, age, experience).
2	Check the candidate against each one; use only what is stated (do not assume).
3	If one criterion fails, see whether an exception applies, and whether the exception's **own conditions** are all met.
4	If nothing applies, the candidate is not selected.

NOTE: Read limits carefully: "at least 60%" includes 60; "not more than 40 years" includes 40. In the PYQ, an enrolled Ph.D. student is not a Ph.D. holder, so the relaxation does not apply.

2.2 Courses of action

A course of action follows if it…	It does not follow if it…
Is practical and directly helps the stated situation	Is extreme, harsh or impractical
Supports the person's plan or solves the problem	Gives up the plan without reason
Takes a preparatory step (plan, arrange money, investigate)	Blames or punishes without evidence
Is within the person's or authority's power	Is unrelated to the statement

SHORTCUT: For courses of action, ask: **Is it useful? Is it practical? Does it support the stated aim?** If yes, it follows; if it quits the aim or punishes, it does not.

CHAPTER 3

Solved PYQs

All three questions with step-by-step reasoning

English 2019 Q45

Recruitment criteria: (i) a graduate in commerce with at least 60% marks; (ii) age at least 24 and not more than 40 years as on 1-4-2018; (iii) post-qualification work experience of at least 2 years; (iv) at least 55% marks in the selection process. Exceptions: (A) not a commerce graduate but a post-graduate in finance with at least 60%: refer to the Finance Manager; (B) all criteria except experience but at least 75% in the selection: refer to the Trainee Accountant. Sumitra is of the proper age, has graduation and post-graduation in commerce with 61% and 63%, has 4.5 years of post-qualification experience as a senior accountant, and has 58.5% in the selection. What is the decision?

1. (i) Commerce graduate with 61%: at least 60%, so satisfied.
2. (ii) Age is according to the advertisement: satisfied.
3. (iii) Experience 4.5 years: at least 2 years, satisfied.
4. (iv) Selection marks 58.5%: at least 55%, satisfied.
5. All four criteria are met, so no exception is needed: the candidate is to be selected.
Answer: Option A (selected)

English 2022 Q50

Criteria to apply for an examination: a master's degree or equivalent from a recognised institution; at least 55% marks, and reserved-category candidates at least 50%; a 5% relaxation is given to Ph.D. degree holders in aggregate marks. Conclusions: I. Candidate X, who belongs to the reserved category and scored 52%, can apply. II. Candidate Y, who has enrolled in a Ph.D. programme and scored 54%, can apply.

1. Conclusion I: a reserved candidate needs at least 50%, X scored 52%, so X can apply.
2. Conclusion II: Y is only **enrolled** in a Ph.D. programme, not a Ph.D. degree holder, so the 5% relaxation does not apply.
3. Y needs 55% (general category) but has 54%, so Y cannot apply.
4. Only conclusion I follows.
Answer: Option B (only I follows)

Mathematics 2024 Q97

Statement: Saxena wants to quit his job at a BPO and start his own business of footwear. Courses of action: (i) Saxena must plan beforehand the details of starting a footwear business. (ii) Saxena must arrange money to start his own business. (iii) Saxena must quit the idea of business and pursue another dream. Which follow?

1. Course (i): planning the details is a practical, preparatory step that supports his aim, so it follows.
2. Course (ii): arranging money is a necessary step in starting a business, so it follows.
3. Course (iii): quitting the idea gives up his plan for no reason, so it does not follow.
4. Both (i) and (ii) follow.
Answer: Option A (both i and ii)

CHAPTER 4

Shortcuts, Traps and Scope

Speed methods and mistakes

- **Tick each criterion** before applying an exception.
- **Use only the given facts**: do not assume a missing fact.
- **“At least” includes the limit**; “more than” excludes it.
- **Course of action:** practical and supportive actions follow; extreme or quitting actions do not.
- **Time:** 45 seconds per question.

Trap	How to avoid it
Applying an exception without meeting its own conditions	Check every condition of the exception.
Assuming a missing fact	Use only the facts in the question.
Confusing enrolled with holder	A degree holder has completed the degree.
Accepting extreme actions	Punishment or giving up the plan rarely follows.

Scope

Related PYQs / topics	Where
Statement and conclusion (logic)	Statement–Conclusion (earlier topic)
Syllogism	Syllogism (earlier topic)

CHAPTER 5

Practice Set

6 original questions; answers on the next page

A. Eligibility

Q1. Criteria: (i) a graduate in commerce with at least 60% marks; (ii) age 24 to 40 years; (iii) at least 2 years of post-qualification experience; (iv) at least 55% marks in the selection process. If a candidate fulfils all the criteria except (i), and is not a commerce graduate but has a post-graduation in finance with at least 60% marks, refer to the Finance Manager. If a candidate fulfils all criteria except (iii) but has at least 75% marks in the selection process, refer to the Trainee Accountant. Ravi is a commerce graduate with 62% marks, aged 35 years (as on the date), with 1 years of post-qualification experience and 78% marks in the selection process. What is the decision?

A. Selected B. Refer to the Trainee Accountant C. Refer to the Finance Manager D. Not selected

Q2. Criteria: (i) a graduate in commerce with at least 60% marks; (ii) age 24 to 40 years; (iii) at least 2 years of post-qualification experience; (iv) at least 55% marks in the selection process. If a candidate fulfils all the criteria except (i), and is not a commerce graduate but has a post-graduation in finance with at least 60% marks, refer to the Finance Manager. If a candidate fulfils all criteria except (iii) but has at least 75% marks in the selection process, refer to the Trainee Accountant. Meena is a arts graduate with 70% marks and a post-graduate in finance with 64%, aged 28 years (as on the date), with 4 years of post-qualification experience and 58% marks in the selection process. What is the decision?

A. Selected B. Refer to the Trainee Accountant C. Not selected D. Refer to the Finance Manager

Q3. Criteria: (i) a graduate in commerce with at least 60% marks; (ii) age 24 to 40 years; (iii) at least 2 years of post-qualification experience; (iv) at least 55% marks in the selection process. If a candidate fulfils all the criteria except (i), and is not a commerce graduate but has a post-graduation in finance with at least 60% marks, refer to the Finance Manager. If a candidate fulfils all criteria except (iii) but has at least 75% marks in the selection process, refer to the Trainee Accountant. Kiran is a commerce graduate with 66% marks, aged 42 years (as on the date), with 5 years of post-qualification experience and 70% marks in the selection process. What is the decision?

A. Selected B. Refer to the Trainee Accountant C. Not selected D. Refer to the Finance Manager

Q4. Criteria to apply for an examination: a master’s degree; at least 55% marks, and reserved-category candidates at least 50%; a 5% relaxation is given to Ph.D. degree holders. Conclusions: I. A reserved-category Ph.D. degree holder with 46% can apply. II. A general-category Ph.D. degree holder with 49% can apply. Which follows?

A. Only conclusion I follows B. Only conclusion II follows C. Both follow D. Neither follows

B. Course of action

Q5. Statement: Many students of a school are failing in Mathematics. Courses of action: (i) Teachers should give extra classes to the weak students. (ii) Mathematics should be removed from the syllabus. (iii) The school should find the reasons for the poor results. Which follow?

A. Only (i) B. Both (ii) and (iii) C. Both (i) and (iii) D. All three

Q6. Statement: A fire broke out in a village near a forest. Courses of action: (i) The fire brigade should be sent at once. (ii) The villagers should be moved to safe places. (iii) The villagers should be punished. Which follow?

A. Only (i) B. Both (i) and (ii) C. Both (ii) and (iii) D. All three

Answer key

Q	Answer	Reason
1	B	Commerce 62%, age 35 and selection 78% are fine, but experience is only 1 year (criterion iii fails). All other criteria are met and the selection marks are at least 75%, so exception B applies: refer to the Trainee Accountant.
2	D	She is not a commerce graduate (criterion i fails) but has a finance post-graduation with 64% (at least 60%). Age 28, experience 4 years and selection 58% are fine, so exception A applies: refer to the Finance Manager.
3	C	Age 42 is above 40 (criterion ii fails). Neither exception covers an age failure, so the candidate is not selected.
4	A	Reserved needs 50%, less 5% for a Ph.D. holder = 45%: 46% is enough, so I follows. General needs 55%, less 5% = 50%: 49% is not enough, so II does not follow.
5	C	Extra classes and finding the reasons are practical steps that address the problem. Removing the subject is extreme and does not solve it.
6	B	Sending help and moving people to safety are direct, practical steps. Punishing the villagers is not related to controlling the fire.

CHAPTER 6

Quick Revision

One page for the last day

Type	Rule
Eligibility	Check every criterion; apply an exception only if all its conditions are met
At least / not more than	The limit itself is included
Enrolled ≠ holder	Relaxations for holders do not apply to enrolled students
Course of action	Practical, direct, supportive actions follow
Extreme actions	Do not follow

PYQ RULE: Eng 2019 Q45: all four criteria met, so selected. Eng 2022 Q50: the enrolled Ph.D. student gets no relaxation. Maths 2024 Q97: planning and arranging money follow; quitting does not.

ROUTINE: Exam-day routine: list the criteria; check each; apply exceptions only if exact; for courses of action ask useful, practical and supportive. 45 seconds per question.